

Sahayak AI: Simple Scam Shield for Senior Citizens

A simple, voice-first verification service on WhatsApp & Toll-Free Call that helps elderly Indians detect scams instantly.

1. SECTOR

Technology for Social Good

2. PROBLEM STATEMENT

Verify calls, links & messages for elders

3. USER ENTRY POINTS

WhatsApp Bot & Toll-Free Audio Call

ITEM 1: PROBLEM DESCRIPTION & PROPOSED SOLUTION

The Problem: Older adults across India are facing severe financial fraud via fake courier updates, electricity bill disconnection threats, pension KYC deactivation warnings, and intimidating "digital arrest" calls by people impersonating police officers. Existing security apps are cluttered with complex technical menus, English-only alerts, and tiny links that create confusion and panic instead of helping.

The Sahayak AI Solution: We remove all technical complexity. Rather than learning new software, seniors use what they already know: **WhatsApp** and **simple phone calls**.

Channel 1: WhatsApp Forwarding

The senior forwards any suspicious message, link, or payment screenshot to a dedicated WhatsApp number. The system instantly checks it and replies with a clear **Traffic Light (Red/Amber/Green)** card plus a friendly 10-second audio voice note in their regional language.

Channel 2: Toll-Free Voice Check

When receiving a high-pressure scam phone call, the elder can dial a toll-free number and describe what they were told in their mother tongue (e.g., Hindi, Tamil, Marathi). Sahayak detects fear triggers and tells them clearly whether to hang up.

ITEM 2: CLEARLY IDENTIFIED AUDIENCE & BENEFICIARIES

- **Primary Beneficiaries:** Senior citizens (aged 55+) across Tier-1, Tier-2, and rural India who use smartphones for daily calls and digital payments (UPI) but cannot navigate complex cybersecurity tools.
- **Secondary Beneficiaries:** Children living or working away from home who worry about their parents being scammed. If a high-risk red alert occurs, the elder's designated family guardian receives a quiet SMS notification.

ITEM 3: SOCIAL ISSUE ADDRESSED & POSITIVE IMPACT

Social Trauma Avoided: Losing life savings and pensions to cybercriminals causes acute depression, severe anxiety, and complete withdrawal from modern digital convenience.

Positive Impact: Sahayak AI protects personal autonomy. It replaces panic with calm, clear reassurance in the elder's own language, ensuring they can enjoy digital banking safely and with dignity.

ITEM 4: HOW IT WORKS IN 3 PLAIN STEPS

Step 1: Senior Receives a Threatening Message

Example: "Your electricity will be cut tonight at 9:30 PM due to an unpaid bill. Call this 10-digit number immediately to update KYC."

Step 2: Simple Forwarding to Sahayak AI

The elder forwards the message or screenshot to the Sahayak WhatsApp contact. No typing, downloading, or account login is required.

Step 3: Clear Regional Voice & Visual Answer

Within 3 seconds, Sahayak AI cross-references verified DISCOM sender IDs and common urgency templates. It returns a bold **RED ALERT** graphic along with a calm regional voice note: "This is a fake message. Real electricity offices never use personal mobile numbers. Do not send any money. You are safe."

WHY SAHAYAK AI BEATS OTHER OPTIONS

Factor	Traditional Apps (Truecaller, Antivirus)	Sahayak AI (Our Approach)
Effort for Senior	Requires setup, permissions, reading small text	Zero Effort (Just forward on WhatsApp)
Language	Mostly technical English jargon	Regional Audio Voice Notes (Hindi, Marathi, etc.)
Scam Type Handled	Only checks known caller IDs	Analyzes Full Message Content & urgency patterns
Family Peace of Mind	Leaves elder alone to decide	Automatic Family Alert on severe threats

SIMPLE 3-PHASE IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

- **Phase 1 (Months 1–3): WhatsApp Bot Pilot** — Build regional scam detection for the top 5 common scams (electricity, pension, courier, digital arrest, APK downloads). Pilot with 1,000 seniors via elder-care associations.
- **Phase 2 (Months 4–6): Voice Hotline & Family Alerts** — Launch the toll-free IVR line using open speech-to-text models (Bhashini) and activate optional emergency SMS alerts to family caregivers.
- **Phase 3 (Months 7–12): Scaled Community Outreach** — Partner with banks and Tata community development programs to make the service permanently free for every senior citizen nationwide.